

Top 5 Don't Dos:

1. Say less (or as much) with more. The title of this section is a prime example of using unnecessary content (the redundant “Do”). Except, in this case, it wasn't completely unnecessary, having served as an illustrative example. There is already information overload in our world, it doesn't need more fluff. Make less more.

2. Add flair. While design does involve looking good, a trendy style shouldn't trump usability. Anything that isn't strictly necessary must go, and this applies to design elements as well. Don't go overboard on the visuals. There's a time and place for being artistic, but this isn't it.

3. Take away control. Users should be given the feeling of being in control, with a logical correspondence between their actions and the usage of the product/service. Things that surprise users like auto-playing videos or links opening in new tabs take away the feeling of control, so don't employ such devices unless absolutely necessary or if the behaviour is expected.

4. Make users wait. Human beings, especially the internet generation, have limited patience. Every design choice will have an impact on the performance speed, so keep this in mind when using high-res images on your website! Don't sacrifice speed and efficiency for anything. Usability is more important than aesthetics.

5. Hinder content with design. Design is meant to complement content, if not enhance its readability, and not hinder it. Design shouldn't be at war with the content, so don't be conceited when it comes to design. Color schemes that decrease typographical contrast and busy backgrounds that detract attention from the text are prime examples of what to avoid.

Top 5 Do's:

1. Ensure everything functions. Nothing kills the joy of usage more than unresponsive links or buttons. They're like being led turn after turn, to a dead end. Even you wouldn't appreciate that experience! Ideally, it should all be working after your last round of user testing, however, since there's no real *last* round, check everything before deploying!

2. Minimise confusion. A human has limited attention. Avoid competing